MAGINHAWA · FOOD SAFETY · BRIEF FOR AN ENVIRONMENTAL HEALTH OFFICER

Checking our digital food-safety records before launch

Draft for discussion · prepared 27 October 2026 · all figures are our proposed settings, not records

Why we're asking. Maginhawa runs 9 restaurants in London. We are replacing paper food-safety diaries with our own phone and tablet app. Before staff rely on it, we want an officer to confirm that the rules it enforces are right, and that its records would count as evidence of due diligence (Food Safety Act 1990, s.21). This brief lists exactly what we'd like you to check.

1 What the app records

Daily checks. Opening, closing, hot holding and fridge/freezer temperatures, with a time and the person's name on every answer. A failed reading must be fixed and re-checked.

Probes. Weekly calibration in iced and boiling water. A probe that fails can't be used for checks until it passes.

Deliveries and recalls. Supplier (approved list only), chilled temperature, batch codes and use-by dates. FSA alerts are matched to the batches we received.

Complaints, inspections and notices, with deadlines for fixes and appeals.

Cooking and cooling. Core temperature for each batch cooked or reheated. A cooling timer starts when food comes off the heat.

Allergens. The 14 allergens for each dish. Every version is kept, and staff confirm they've read each change.

People. Hygiene certificates with expiry dates. A fit-to-work question at the start of each shift.

Records you can trust. Finished checklists are locked. A supervisor can correct an answer only by giving a reason, and the old answer, who changed it and when stay visible. Times come from our server, not the device.

2 Rules the app enforces: please confirm

Rule	Our setting	Basis	Our question	Confirmed?
Fridges and chilled food	**warn > 5°C** **fail > 8°C**	LAW 8°C GUIDANCE 5°C	Is warning at 5°C and failing at 8°C the right split? Or should anything above 5°C count as a fail?	☐ Yes ☐ Change
Freezers	**–18°C or below**	GUIDANCE	Is –18°C the right fail point, or should we allow a margin while the freezer is being restocked or defrosted?	☐ Yes ☐ Change
Hot holding	**63°C or above**	LAW	Do we need a rule for the 2-hour exception, or is this simple rule enough?	☐ Yes ☐ Change
Cooking core temperature	**75°C or above**	GUIDANCE	Should we also accept equivalent time and temperature combinations (e.g. 70°C for 2 minutes)?	☐ Yes ☐ Change
Reheating	**75°C or above**	GUIDANCE	Correct for England? (We understand Scotland requires 82°C.)	☐ Yes ☐ Change
Cooling hot food	**into the fridge within 90 min**	GUIDANCE	Is 90 minutes the right limit? Should staff also record a temperature when the food goes in?	☐ Yes ☐ Change
Probe calibration	**weekly · ice –1 to 1°C · boiling 99 to 101°C**	GUIDANCE	Are the weekly frequency and these ranges right?	☐ Yes ☐ Change
Off work after vomiting or diarrhoea	**48 hours after symptoms stop**	GUIDANCE	Is a yes/no question at the start of each shift enough? Only managers see the answers.	☐ Yes ☐ Change
Hygiene certificate expiry	**warn 30 days before**	OUR CHOICE	What level of training do you expect for each role (kitchen, front of house, managers)?	☐ Yes ☐ Change
Repeat faults	**same check fails 3+ times in 7 days**	OUR CHOICE	These are flagged in a signed review every 4 weeks. Is that a sensible trigger and review frequency?	☐ Yes ☐ Change

3 How long we keep records: please advise

We understand there is no fixed legal period for most food-safety records. These are our suggestions. Nothing is deleted without head office's approval.

Record	We suggest	Our reasoning	Confirmed?
Temperatures and checks, including corrections	**2 years**	Covers inspection cycles and most claims	☐ Yes ☐ Change
Faults and how they were fixed	**2 years**	Kept alongside the checks they came from	☐ Yes ☐ Change
Allergen versions for each dish	**3 years**	So we can show what a guest was told on a given date	☐ Yes ☐ Change
Complaints and incidents	**3 years**	Personal injury claim time limit	☐ Yes ☐ Change
Training certificates	**until the person leaves, plus 2 years**	Shows training was in place at the time	☐ Yes ☐ Change
Fit-to-work answers	**6 months**	Health data; UK GDPR says keep it as short as possible	☐ Yes ☐ Change
Inspections and notices	**6 years**	Matches the general limitation period	☐ Yes ☐ Change

4 Records and evidence: our questions

1. **Digital instead of paper.** Would you accept these digital records in place of the SFBB diary pages? Is there anything from the diary that we're missing?
2. **Corrections.** We never overwrite: a correction keeps the original answer, the reason, the person and the server time. Is that enough for a record to be trusted?
3. **The inspection pack.** On a visit, a manager can print one pack for chosen dates: temperatures and checks, faults, allergens, cooking and cooling, probes, deliveries, training, complaints, and inspections. Health answers and customer details are left out. Is that what you'd want to see, and is reading it on screen acceptable?
4. **The written plan.** The app records the checks, but it doesn't hold our HACCP-based food safety management system. Is a written SFBB pack for each site, kept alongside the app, the right approach?
5. **One answer for 9 sites.** Our sites fall under more than one London council. Would you recommend a Primary Authority partnership, and could your council act as ours?

5 What we'll bring

The app on a phone and an iPad, with example records. A printed sample inspection pack. Our draft SFBB pack. The list of approved suppliers.

Notes from the meeting

Officer name and council

For Maginhawa

Date

Basis key: **LAW** set in legislation (Food Hygiene (England) Regulations 2013 and retained EU food hygiene law) · **GUIDANCE** FSA or SFBB guidance · **OUR CHOICE** our own policy. Our reading of the law and guidance is not legal advice; that is why we're asking you to confirm it. Contact: